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5 skills that keep engineers hired

Layoffs are everywhere, but AI hiring in India is growing. None of these skills is "just prompting": companies want engineers who can **ship and run AI**. Here's a 10-week plan.

+25%
AI & ML hiring on Naukri, year on year

−3%
IT services hiring, same period

10
weeks, 2 per skill, 1 portfolio project

THE 10-WEEK PATH

- 🔎 **Querying data** — WEEKS 1–2
- 🧠 **Building on LLMs** — WEEKS 3–4
- 📈 **LLMOps** — WEEKS 5–6
- ⚙️ **Workflow automation** — WEEKS 7–8
- 🔐 **Cloud + security for AI** — WEEKS 9–10

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Weeks 1–6

1 🔎 Querying data

WEEKS 1–2

LinkedIn lists querying as India's fastest-growing engineering skill.

1. SELECT, WHERE, GROUP BY, JOINs
2. Window functions and CTEs
3. Answer 10 real questions on a public dataset

YOU'LL BUILD
A SQL notebook that answers business questions

LEARN FREE
SQLBolt · Mode SQL Tutorial

2 🧠 Building on LLMs

WEEKS 3–4

Calling a model is easy. Making it reliable is the skill.

1. Call an LLM API and stream the answer
2. RAG over your own documents
3. An agent with 2–3 tools, plus evals

YOU'LL BUILD
A "chat with your docs" app that cites sources

LEARN FREE
Anthropic & OpenAI docs and cookbooks

3 📈 LLMOps

WEEKS 5–6

Know what the AI did, what it cost and whether it still works.

1. Deploy it; add logging and tracing
2. Track cost and latency per request
3. Version prompts; run evals on every change

YOU'LL BUILD
A dashboard of cost, latency and eval scores

LEARN FREE
Langfuse or LangSmith docs

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Weeks 7–10

4 ⚙️ Workflow automation

WEEKS 7–8

AI that does real work gets noticed in reviews.

1. Pick one boring weekly task
2. Automate it end to end
3. Measure hours saved

YOU'LL BUILD
One automation your team actually uses

LEARN FREE
n8n docs · your cloud's functions docs

5 🔐 Cloud + security for AI

WEEKS 9–10

Every agent needs an identity, secrets and limits.

1. IAM and least privilege on one cloud
2. Secrets manager + short-lived credentials
3. Private endpoints and egress rules

YOU'LL BUILD
Lock down your app: no keys in code, least privilege

LEARN FREE
AWS IAM docs · HashiCorp Vault tutorials

Your portfolio project

Combine all five: a docs assistant (2) that answers from a database (1), runs in production with tracing (3), automates one real task (4), and keeps its keys in a vault with least-privilege access (5). Put it on GitHub. Follow @dabeer.ai for more.